QP CODE: 24900096

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
I SEMESTER MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2024
First Semester
Multi-Disciplinary Course - MG1MDCENG100 - FOLK TALES AND SONGS FROM INDIA
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1.5 Hours Maximum Marks: 50

Remember (K), Understand (U), Apply (A), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C), Interest (I), Appreciation (Ap), and Skill (S)

Students should attempt atleast one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

[Learning Domain][CO No(s)]

Part **A**

Multiple Choice Questions. Answer **All** questions. Each question carries **1** mark

1. What was the impact of the Criminal Tribes Act of 1871? [K] [1,2,3]
   d) Around 200 communities were labeled as 'criminal tribes'
2. Who discussed the "joint production of meaning" in cultures? [K] [1,2,3]
   b) Mary Douglas
3. " Tell it to the Walls" is a [K] [4]
   c) Tamil Folktale
4. What is the moral of the story Bopoluchi? [An] [4]
   d) Intelligence can overcome even the strongest enemy
5. Identify the author of the song Paalom Paalom. [U] [5,6]
   a) Jithesh Kakkidippuram

(5 × 1 = 5)

Part **B**

Objective Type Questions. Answer any **10** questions. Each question carries **1** mark

6. Who was tasked with bringing the monolith from Ceylon? [K] [4]
   A Rajput
7. Which are the animals present in The Legend of the Dhorawat Tank? [K] [4]
   A calf, a horse and a cock.
8. Who helped Kochunny find a job in Evoor? [K] [4, 6]
   A kind gentleman
9. List the poetic devices that are used in Garhwali songs. [U] [5]
   Metaphor, allusion
10. How does the speaker express his longing in the third Chattisgarhi song? [U] [5]
    The refrain “How dark my bed is now” emphasizes the longing the poet feels for the beloved.
11. Who said that poetry is a constituent as well as part of culture? [K] [1, 2, 3]
    Paul Friedrich
12. The term 'tribal' in India is not a synonym for Indigenous [K] [1, 2, 3]
13. In Paalom Paalom which is the Malayalam word used to describe the month? [U] [5, 6]

Varuthi masam/ Kalla karkidakam

14. What does the narrator suggest about the relationship between life and art with respect to Mudiyattam? [K] [5, 6]
Life and art are inseparable.

15. What did the "lid above" in Akbar's Riddle symbolize? [U] [4]
Upper lid symbolises the sky.

16. How did Kochunny save his master from drowning? [K] [4, 6]
When he was caught in squall and the boatmen were unable to control the boat, Kochunny took the oars and guided the small craft through the storm to a safe haven.

17. How does the goddess find that Naranathu Bhranthan was no ordinary man? [U] [4, 6]
When the Goddess tried to frighten him, he smiled at their antics with amusement.

(10 × 1 = 10)

Part **C**

Short Answer Questions (50 Words). Answer any **5** questions. Each question carries **2** marks

18. Describe what happened to the mother in the song Paalom Paalom. [U] [5, 6]
The lord ordered the woman to be sacrificed to save the land from the famine. They believed that only a woman's blood would strengthen the bridge they are building.

19. How is the song on Arjun and Draupadi distinct? [An] [5]
It's a playful exchange between Arjun and Droupadi from the Mahabharata.

20. What is the significance of 'denotified' tribal communities? [K] [1, 2, 3]
Denotified tribes are a group of marginalized communities in India that face discrimination and are considered vulnerable and deprived. They were labeled as "born criminals" under the British colonial-era Criminal Tribes Act of 1871. The Indian government repealed these acts in 1992, and the communities were "denotified" but they still remain marginalized.

21. How did the younger sister become a flowering tree? [K] [4]
The younger sister becomes a flowering tree through a magical ritual performed. The older sister pours water from the first pitcher over the younger sister and she transforms into a tree.

22. How did prince Sabar realize that his wife was his doctor? [K] [4]
After Prince Sabor was brought back to life, his wife told him it was she who had brought him back to life.

23. How did Bopoluchi's boasting to her friends indirectly lead to her capture by the robber? [U][4]
The robber overhears Bopoluchi's boasting that her uncle would bring clothes,jewels and savory food and decides to capture her posing as her uncle.

24. What impact did the bhadralok's views have on traditional songs? [An] [1, 2, 3]
The new sense of morality the badralog represented rejected the Radha-Krishna motif in plays and dances that depicted human passions, sensuality and eroticism.
There was an attempt to portray all forms of native art as obscene.

25. Who are often the subjects of traditional feminist literature? [K] [1, 2, 3]

Upper-caste woman, or badramahila, is given prominence. Her superiority over the coarse, uneducated woman, devoid of refinement, is stressed.

(5 × 2 = 10)

Part **D**

Short Essay Questions (150 Words). Answer any **2** questions. Each question carries **5** marks

26. Discuss the historical and social complexities in defining tribal identity in India. [An] [1, 2, 3]

GN Devi states that it is very difficult to define the term 'tribal' in the Indian context as it is too layered to be a synonym for indigenous. The tribals of our country do not belong to a single racial group nor can we say that they are the original inhabitants of a particular region. Also, there are several instances of long-distance nomadism in the subcontinent. In addition, the tribal population of our country has not remained totally cut off from the non-tribals. Exchanges between the two communities have been widespread from the very ancient times in the fields of medicine, folklore, narrative technique, religious abstraction, music, dance, theatre, and, even, agricultural techniques.

27. What is the role of 'kismet' in one's life? [An] [4]

Prince Sabar- Sultan asked all his seven daughters about the cause of their prosperity and happiness, if it was their own kismet or his - first six daughters replied that it was his good stars that kept them happy. But his youngest daughter said that each one of them had his/her own kismet which brought them good and evil.

28. How did Chappens mindfulness save his friend? [An] [4, 6]

Othenan's friend Chappen waited outside the fortress for his return unaware of his captivity- suspected of misfortune -returned to Kadathanad-arranged a thousand soldiers - disguised as a Yogi -met Kelappan and won his trust - advised him to hang him on a convenient date.

29. What role do mythological narratives play in shaping community identities according to C J Kuttappan? [An] [5, 6]

Most of the art forms and ritual forms emerged out of societies divided into classes, races, castes, etc. and belong to particular communities. For example, Pulluvan Paattu belongs to the Pulluva community and Panan Paattu to the Panan community. There are also songs of Pulayas and Parayas

(2 × 5 = 10)

Part **E**

Essay Questions (300 Words). Answer any **1** question. Each question carries **15** marks

30. How do the themes in The Legend of the Dhorawat Tank reflect the cultural values and beliefs of the region from which the tale originates? [An] [4]

Story about construction of a water tank in Rajasthan - Kunwah hills- fate of a stone that was intended to be placed at the centre of the tank but was never installed -tale follows a common pattern found in legends about the construction of monuments and similar structures around the world- importance of water – kindness

31. Examine the cultural significance of Oppari singing in relation to community bonding and emotional expression. [An] [5, 6]

These songs are not merely an emotional outlet, but provide a platform for women to speak out against social injustice -social norms and gender discrimination.Historically, Tamil women were marginalised from the traditional modes of literary expression, such as reading, writing, and street theatre - Tamil women used these songs to transgress the boundaries of their homes, from a private to a public domain - Traditionally, oppari was predominantly sung by young widows, to lament and ponder over their fate. In Tamil society, a widowed woman was considered inauspicious, and was subject to severe ostracisation. Through oppari, the young widow could express her pent-up emotions and discontent-oppari also provided a secular stage for women of different ages and social backgrounds.

(1 × 15 = 15)